

Points Scoring and Protection

This session focuses on protecting or setting up points on scoring passes.

Overview

Pre-Session: Off Skates Warm-up 5-10 Minutes

Lightly making sure that the joints still work.

Focus is **not** on building strength, cardio or endurance, just on limbering up. Do 5 to 10 reps of each, on each side.

- Toe taps + one leg light squats
- Arm, shoulder and neck stretches
- Opening and closing hip rotations
- Knee raise to superman
- Cross chest knee raises
- Butt kicks, high knees, side shuffles

Warm Up - 10 Minutes

This session will involve some crossovers, particularly backwards ones, so this is included in the warm-up.

- Sticky skating - Regular, Figure 8, low
- Weaves focusing on 180 degree turns
- Crossover-Carves
- One foot lateral glides
- 1 minute crossovers, 1 minute backwards crossovers, 1 minute anti-derby crossovers, 1 minute anti-derby backwards crossovers.

Followed by any dynamic stretching and stopping.

One Foot Blocking - 10 minutes

Start with two foot blocking to find edges if needed.

Warming up edges with some contact. One skater driving, the other skater blocking on one foot. Extend with some more exotic drives for offence practice.

- Shoulder drive into Chest drive
- Hip drive into Chest drive
- Shelf drive starting engaged.

Look ma, no hands on the lines

Look ma no hands, but with a catching brace. Jammers are free to jam, and start two feet behind the wall.

Spending Points

Spending points drill. Goal is for blockers to start with a defensive posture, then get more offensive when their points have been taken. Notes.

Scoring pass offence

Offence practice with a jammer on a three wall.

- Take the brace
- Seam to brace offence
- Outside to brace

Once the basics have been drilled, move into the jammer doing laps. Wall is not yet allowed to run away. Blockers should focus on the spending points drill.

Chasedown

Putting it all together, a jammer chasedown drill with offence and point defence. Goal is to points and call.

Drill Notes

Drill: Chest Drive

This drill requires pairs of skaters.

Starting engaged, one skater is driving the other blocking, with both skaters starting in the middle of the track.

The driving skater should attempt to use their chest to drive the other blocker. The skater being driven should attempt to hold their position (rather than simply skating away).

The idea of this drive is to push from a chest-on-chest position, using a combination of the direction of play, and the momentum from an initial, alternative drive to get the skater moving.

This is best started from a shoulder drive, either low or regular, then ends in a chest drive. Keeping one leg down-track from the blocker prevents them from rotating in that direction, ideally getting them onto toe-stops further limits their ability to get out of the situation, which is helped by lifting them with the initial shoulder drive.

Practice in pairs, and rotate skaters where possible - driving is best practiced against a wide range of different opponents. Also don't forget to practice driving to both the inside and outside.

Drill: Shelf Drive

This drill requires pairs of skaters.

Starting engaged, one skater is driving the other blocking, with both skaters starting in the middle of the track.

The driving skater should attempt to shelf and drive the other blocker. The skater being driven should attempt to hold their position (rather than simply skating away).

This is a mix of the hip and shoulder drive. Setting up with a leg placed laterally beneath the blocker, and a shoulder in the same position as the shoulder drive, the idea is to perform a lateral directly into the blocker. It is important to not engage the toe stop under the target blocker, as this will burn off the momentum of the drive. Additionally it is important to start the engagement with either the hip, or the shoulder - starting with the thigh under the other blocker is a back block if any impact is achieved, and the purpose of the drive is to cause impact.

Using a 'skateboard' lateral push, or a toe-stop push continue to drive the other blocker off the track. The shoulder and thigh set up prevents the blocker from getting low - limiting the friction they can generate to resist the push.

Practice in pairs, and rotate skaters where possible - driving is best practiced against a wide range of different opponents. Also don't forget to practice driving to both the inside and outside.

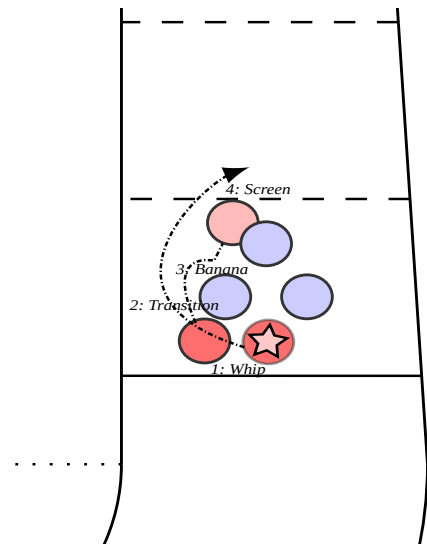
Drill: Hip Whip Screen

A screening offence drill.

This drill requires a jammer, a three wall and an offence, the jammer begins engaged but behind the seam.

The offence begins with a hip whip on the jammer, into a banana block on one of the rear butts. Tracking and screening the jammer, this is then finished with a second transition and then screen the brace, clearing the line.

The blockers should attempt to resist by either driving the offence into the jammer on the line, while the free blocker can attempt to run to the front, recatch and support a reform of the wall on the jammer.



Jammer follows their offence down the line.

Drill: Spending Points

This drill requires enough blockers to challenge a jammer, and someone emulating a bench coach.

This drill focuses on blockers looking to 'spend' their points to hold back the jammer, or if the jammer has already taken the point, to use the new freedom the blocker now has to drive the jammer.

Use either a two, three or four wall to match the jammer to a point where they are unlikely to escape without offence. A three or four wall is preferred.

The jammer is free to jam and has between 10 and 40 seconds to score as many points as they can. The jammer may not know how long they have remaining, all they know is that when their bench says to call they have to call.

This emulates either clearing a skater from the penalty box, or trying to score points before the other jammer reaches the wall. The jammer is on a timer and does not expect to complete a pass beyond this one.

The blockers are looking not to protect their points, but to spend them efficiently. The idea being that if a jammer has the full forty seconds to score points while the wall tries to hold the score at zero, the jammer is more likely to take the whole wall. The most efficient way to prevent the jammer from scoring points is to take them off the track and recycle them.

To achieve this the wall should recognise whose point has already been taken, and hence who is now free to take an inferior position and drive the jammer.

- If all points are still in play, then the wall should either look to spend one point for a drive, or hold the jammer scoreless.
- If the jammer has scored a point, that blocker is now 'free' to drive the jammer without concern for position.
- If the jammer has scored two points then more elaborate four wall pockets are possible.

Progression: Add an offence to support the jammer.

Drill: Doing Laps

This is a powerjam drill, it requires at least one jammer, one pack of defensive blockers and some offensive blockers.

The jammer starts from the edge of the front of the engagement zone as if they had just been awarded lead. They have 30 seconds to score as many points as they can before an optional second jammer is released to return to track.

Their blockers should look at setting up a chain of offensive moves.

Drill: Scoring Pass Chasedown

This drill requires two jammer and two groups of blockers.

The jammers begin with one jammer at front edge of the engagement zone, and the other 30-50 feet ahead of the engagement zone (depending on the relative speed of the jammers), as if both have just completed their initial pass.

Both jammers begin at the same time. The forward jammer is the lead jammer - their goal is points and call, holding the other jammer scoreless.

The rear jammer's goal is to shank points or pressure for a 0-0 jam. The blockers should immediately consider how to setup points up for their jammer, or to deny points to the opposing jammer.

The lead blockers should focus on capturing goats, or hitting blockers out and recycling them for easy collection. They should also be wary to release their captive points to prevent themselves being scored on by the opposing jammer.

The non-lead blockers should similarly be focusing on either extending the jam by taking the front, on not being goated, and on avoiding being scored on.